



(English Medium)

BRAHMASTRA



COSMOS

STATIC GK

FACTs+PYQs

NCERT BASED

History | Art and culture | Indian polity | Geography | Environment
Economy | Science and Technology | Computer | Sports | Miscellaneous

UPSC (CSE, NDA, CDS, CAPF)

Railway (NTPC, RPF, ALP, JE)

Banking (IBPSPO, IBPSClerk, RBI Ass.)

SSC (CGL, CHSL, CPO, MTS, Steno)

State Exams (UPPCS, BPSC, MPPCS, RAS, CGPCS, UPSI, UPSSSC, BSSC)

and useful for other competitive examinations.

TM No. 01181859



Mahesh Kumar Barnwal (IPS)

Indramani Patel

These ebooks are free of cost, Join our telegram channel: @apna_pdf



Click Here To Join our
Telegram Channel

These ebooks are free of
cost, Join our telegram
channel: @apna_pdf

Important National and International Days

January

- 4 January International World Braille Day
- 9 January Pravasi Bharatiya Diwas
- 10 January World Hindi Day
- 11 January National Human Trafficking Awareness Day
- 12 January National Youth Day (India)
- 15 January Indian Army Day
- 16 January National Start-up Day
- 23 January Valour (Parakram) Day (Birthday of Subhash Chandra Boss)
- 24 January National Girl child day (India)
- 25 January Tourism Day and National Voters Day
- 26 January International Customs Day
- 27 January International Holocaust Remembrance Day
- 30 January Martyrs' Day (Mahatma Gandhi)

February

- 2 February World Wetlands Day
- 4 February World Cancer Day
- 10 February National De-Worming Day
- 13 February National Women Day
- 21 February International Mother Language Day
- 28 February National Science Day (India)

March

- 1 March World Civil Defence Day
- 3 March World Wildlife Day
- 4 March National Security Day
- 8 March International Women's Day
- 14 March International Day of Action for Rivers
- 15 March World Consumer Rights Day
- 16 March National Vaccination Day
- 20 March International Day of Happiness
- 21 March World Forestry Day
- 22 March World Day for Water
- 23 March World Meteorological Day
- 24 March World Tuberculosis Day
- 27 March World Theatre Day

April

- 7 April World Health Day
- 10 April World Homeopathy Day
- 17 April World Haemophilia Day
- 18 April World Heritage Day
- 22 April Earth Day

- 23 April World Book and Copyright Day
- 24 April National Panchayati Raj Day
- 25 April World Malaria Day
- 26 April World Intellectual Property Day
- 28 April World Day for Safety and Health at Work

May

- 1 May International Labour Day
- 2 May International Astronomy Day
- 4 May World Asthma Day
- 7 May World Athletics Day
- 10 May World Mother Day
- 11 May National Technology Day (India)
- 12 May International Nurses Day
- 17 May World Telecommunication Day
- 18 May International Museum Day
- 20 May World Metrology Day
- 22 May International Day for Biological Diversity
- 28 May International Day of Action for Women's Health
- 31 May World Anti-Tobacco Day

June

- 1 June World Milk Day
- 4 June International Day of Innocent Children Victims of Aggression
- 7 June World Food Safety Day
- 8 June World Ocean Day
- 12 June World Day Against Child Labour
- 16 June International Integration Day
- 17 June World Day to Combat Desertification and Drought
- 19 June World Sickle Cell Day
- 20 June World Refugee Day
- 21 June International Yoga Day
- 23 June International Olympic Day
- 29 June National Statistics Day

July

- 1 July National Doctor's Day (India)
- 4 July International Cooperative Day
- 11 July World Population Day
- 17 July World Day for International Justice
- 26 July Kargil Memorial Day (India)
- 28 July World Hepatitis Day
- 29 July International Tiger Day
- 30 July International Day of Friendship



(English Medium)

BRAHMASTRA

COSMOS

STATIC GK

FACTs+PYQs

Based on NCERT



History | Art and culture | Indian polity | Geography | Environment
Economy | Science and Technology | Computer | Sports | Miscellaneous

UPSC (CSE, NDA, CDS, CAPF)

Railway (NTPC, RPF, ALP, JE)

Banking (IBPS Po, IBPS Clerk, RBI Ass.)

SSC (CGL, CHSL, CPO, MTS, Steno)

State Exams (UPPCS, BPSC, MPPCS, RAS, CGPCS, UPSI, UPSSSC, BSSSC)

and useful for other competitive examinations
for more books like this search @apna_pdf on
telegram and join.

Mahesh Kumar Barnwal (IPS)

Indramani Patel



Search On TG: @apna_pdf



Index

These ebooks are free of cost, Join our telegram channel: @apna_pdf

History of Ancient India

• Parts of History	1
• Historical Sources	1
• Important Literatures of Ancient India	2
• Important Inscriptions & Related Facts	2
• Chalcolithic Sites	2
• Neolithic Sites	3
• Indus Valley Civilization Sites	3-4
• Major Precious items Imports by the Indus Valley Civilization	4
• Major Ancient Vedic Terms	5
• Rig Vedic Period Rivers	5
• 16 Major Rituals	5
• Types of Marriage (According to Grihya Sutras)	5
• 24 th Tirthankara of Jain Religion : Mahavira Swami	6
• Major Jain Tirthankaras and their Symbols	6
• Five Principles of Jainism	6
• Jain Councils	6
• Three Jewels of Jainism	6
• Founder of Buddhism : Mahatma Buddha	7
• Symbols related to life events of Buddha	7
• Buddhist Councils	7
• 16 Mahajanapadas and their Capital	8
• Empire of Magadha	8
• Titles held by Ashoka	9
• 14 Major Rock Edicts of Ashoka	9
• Pillars Inscription of Ashoka	10
• Foreign Invasion in Post Maurya Period	10
• Titles held by Gupta rulers	11
• Ancient Books and their Authors	11
• Nine Jewels of Chandragupta II	11

History of Medieval India

• Wars/Battles of Medieval India and Related Facts	12
• Dynasties of Delhi Sultanate	13
• Vijayanagara Empire	14
• Dynasties of Vijayanagara Empire	14
• Bahmani Sultanate	15

• 5 Independent States of Bahmani Sultanate	15
• Major Sufi Silsila and related Sufi Saints	15
• Saints and their Sects	16
• Mughal rulers real names and their titles	16
• Important Events of Akbar's Reign	17
• Literary/Texts of Medieval India and their Authors	18
• 10 Sikh Gurus	19
• Maratha Empire	19

History of Modern India

• Arrival of European Companies in India	20
• Anglo-Indian Wars	20
• List of Treaties signed by the Marathas	21
• Land Revenue System in British India	22
• Major Centres of the Revolt of 1857 and Rebel Leaders	22
• Major books based on the Revolution of 1857	22
• Views related to 1857 Uprising	22
• Major Social Legislations under the British	23
• Major Tribal Revolts	23
• Major Peasant Movements	24
• British Era Commissions/Committees	25
• Major Revolutionary Events	25
• Major Press Act	26
• Major Slogans and related Personalities	26
• Freedom fighters who went to jail during the Movement Quit India	27
• Father of Nation Mahatma Gandhi : An Introduction	27
• Sobriquet/Titles of Indian Freedom Fighters	28
• Other Important Fact of Modern India	29
• Important Sessions of Indian National Congress	29-30
• Major Institutions, Organizations and their Founders in British India	31-32
• Important Papers, Journal and Books in British India	33-34
• Important Movement and Events from Indian freedom struggle	35-36
• Governor Generals/Viceroy and Major Events	37-39
• Questions asked in 2024	40

Miscellaneous		
• Major Dynasties of Indian History, their Capitals and Founders	41	• Major religions and facts related to them 61
• Major Rulers and their Titles	42	• Major Indian Philosophies (Orthodox) 61
• Famous Personality and their Guru	42	• Classical Languages 61
• Famous Poets of Ancient and Medieval India	43	• Major Festivals/celebrations of India 62-63
• Foreign Travelers who Visited India During Different Regimes	44	• Major Traditional Costumes/Dresses of India 64
• Foreign Invasion in India and Related Facts	44	• Famous Traditional Dishes of India 65
• Famous Person and their Real Name	45	• Major Fairs of India 66
• Major Cities of Indian History and their Founders	45-46	• World Heritage Sites of India 67-68
• Coins Issued by Different Dynasties/Rulers	46	• Indian Intangible Cultural Heritage Marked by UNESCO 68
• Major Rulers who were Vassals of an Empire in the Past: (Search @apna_pdf on Telegram)	46	• Major cultural institutions of India 69
Art and Culture		Indian Polity
• Caves/Hills related to Jainism	47	• Constitutional Development in India 70
• Stupas Related to Buddhism	47	• First in Constituent Assembly 70
• Major Caves of India	47-48	• Members of the Drafting Committee 70
• Temples in Gupta Period	48	• 8 Major Committees and their Chairman 71
• Dravidian Style Temples of South Indian Dynasties	48-49	• Minor Committees and their Chairman 71
• Other important temples in India	49-50	• Women Member in the Constituent Assembly 71
• Shri Ram Mandir, Ayodhya (Uttar Pradesh)	51	• Important facts related to the Constituent Assembly 71
• 12 Jyotirlingas of India	51	• Important works done by the Constituent Assembly 71
• 4 Peeths Established by Adi Shankara	51	• Interim Government-1946 72
• Major Buddhist Monasteries of India	51-52	• First Cabinet of Independent India 72
• Architecture related to the dynasties of Medieval India (Mosques/Tombs/Forts)	52-53	• Important facts related to the election of the Constituent Assembly 72
• Important Shrines/Mausoleum	53	• Major Sources of Indian Constitution 73
• Indian Paintings/ Folk Paintings/ Cave Paintings	54	• Preamble of the Constitution 74
• 8 Major Classical dances and their famous artists	55	• Indian Constitution Parts and Related Articles 74-75
• States/Union Territories and their major Folk Dances	56	• Schedules of the Indian Constitution 75
• Puppet Dance and Related States	57	• Languages Included in 8th Schedule 76
• States/Union Territories and their Major Folk Dramas/Theatres	57	• Articles Related to Union and its Territory 76
• Major Martial Arts	58	• Articles Related to Citizenship 76
• States/Union Territories and their Major Folk Music	58	• Fundamental Rights 77
• Important musical instruments and associated musicians	59	• Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP) 78
• Indian Folk Song Instruments	60	• List of Fundamental Duties 78
• Major Musical Gharanas and associated Personalities	61	• Important Articles Related to President 79
		• Indian Presidents and Related important facts 79-80
		• Important Articles Related to Vice President 81
		• Vice President of India and their Tenure 81
		• Important Article related to Union Council of Minister 82
		• Prime Minister of India 82-83

Search On TG: @apna_pdf

• Important Canals of The World	116	• Major Waterfalls of in India	134
• Famous Ports of The World	116	• Major Dams of India	134
• Important ports located on different rivers of the world	116	• Railway : Special Facts	135
• Grasslands of The World	117	• India : Railway Zone	136
• Local Winds of The World	117	• Engine/Coach Production Units of Indian Railways	136
• Major Warm Ocean Current	117	• Important National Highways	137
• Major Cold Ocean Currents	117	• Major National Waterways in India	137
• Sobriquets of Industrial Cities	118	• India : Major International Airports	138
• Major Industrial Centres of The World	118	• 13 Major Ports of India	139
• Major Peninsulas of the world	118	• Major Transport Institutes in India	139
• Major Tribes/Ethnic groups of The World	119	• Major Road Bridges of India	140
• Major disputed regions/islands in past and current scenario	119	• Major Forestry Research Institutes in India	140
• Major Regions and Countries Located in them	120	• Major Mineral Producing States of India (2021-2022)	141
• International Border Lines	120	• Mineral Reserves of India	142
Geography of India		• Oil Refinery Plants in India	143
• India : General Introduction	121	• Petroleum and Natural Gas Basin	143
• Water Boundaries of Indian States and Union Territories	122	• Institutes Related to Electrification	143
• Border of Indian States and Union Territories shared with neighbouring Countries	222	• Tribes of India	144
• Important Peaks of Himalayas	123	Natural Disasters and Managment	
• Top Mountain Peaks in Indian States/Union Territories	123-124	• New classification of seismic zones in India	145
• Major Hill Cities of India	124	• Earthquake Research Organizations of India	145
• Major Plateaus of India and the rivers Originating from them	125	• Major International organizations for Disaster Management	145
• Major Passes of India	125-126	• Nodal Ministry for Management of Various Disasters	145
• Types of Indian Soil	126	Environment and Ecology	
• Traditional Seasons in India	126	• Father Related to Environment Field	146
• Classification of Crops India	127	• Important Days Related to Environment	146-147
• Name of Shifting Cultivation	127	• Important Wildlife Conservation Projects	147
• Different Types of Agriculture	128	• 4 Biodiversity Hotspots in India	147
• Classification of Forests	128	• Biosphere Reserves in India	148
• Major Rivers of Northern India	129	• National Parks in India-106	149
• Major Rivers of Peninsular India	130	• Important Wildlife Sanctuaries in India	150
• Major town Situated on the Bank of Rivers	131	• 55 Tiger Reserves in India	151
• Nicknames of Indian Rivers	132	• Elephant Reserves in India (33)	152
• Major Lakes of India	132	• Important Zoological Parks in India	152
• Major River Valley Projects in India	133	• Ramsar sites in India : Total number-85	153
• List of Interstate Water Disputes	133	• Important Bird Sancturues in India	154
		• Major Pollution and Their Effects	155
		• Famous Environmentalists in India	156-157
		• Important Environmental Institutions of India	157
		• Important Act Related to Environment	158

Search @apna_pdf on Telegram

• Environment Movements and related Facts	158	• Important Government Schemes	175-176
• Important Award of Environmental Conservation	159	• Major theories and their proponents	176
• Top Environmental Institute of The World	159	• Global Reports and Index : 2022-24	177
• Important Committee Related to Environmental	159	• International Organizations	178
• Major International Environmental Conventions and Treaties	160		
Economy		Physics	
• Types of Economy	161	• Important Physical Quantities and Their Units	179
• Important books and Authors	161	• Formulas and Units of Derived Physical Quantities	180
• Sectors of the Economy	161	• Scalar Quantities/ Vector Quantities	180
• Major Plans in the Economic History of India	161	• Powers of Ten	180
• Five-Years Plans	162	• Basic Unit Conversion List	181
• Establishment of Banks in India	163	• Types of Waves	181
• Merger of Banks	163	• Wavelengths of Light of Different colors	181
• Reserve Bank of India	164	• Sound Sources and their Intensity	182
• Governor of Reserve Bank of India	164	• Types of Sound Waves	182
• Banking Sector Reform Committees	165	• Light Phenomenon and Their Reason	182
• Indian Rupee Symbol	165	• Speed of Lights and Refractive Index in Different Matters	183
• Indian notes: Images	165	• Different Mirror and their Uses	183
• Important Regulatory Bodies	166	• Electromagnetic Waves	183
• Important Standard Certificate	167	• Energy conversion	184
• Different Types of ATM	167	• Important Physics Theories/Laws and their Inventors	184
• Modern Banking Payment System	167	• Some effects under the Physics and Chemistry	185
• Indian Security Printing and Coinage Centres	168	• Example of Centripetal Force	185
• History of Budget	168	• Example of Centrifugal Force	185
• Facts Related to GST	169	• Scientific Devices and their Uses	186-187
• Important Small Export Development Centres	169	• Application of Conduction/Convection/Radiation	187
• Agriculture Related Facts	170	• Inventors of Different Machines and Devices	188-189
• Important Agricultural Boards and their Headquarters	170	• Speed of Sound in Different Medium	189
• Important Agricultural Institute	171		
• Major Insurance Companies of India	171	Chemistry	
• Major Credit Rating Agencies	171	• Important Facts Related to Elements	190
• Important Economics Acts	171	• Major Subatomic Particles	190
• Major Stock Exchanges of the World	172	• Discoveries Related to Chemistry	191
• 13 Maharatna Companies	172	• Symbols and Atomic Numbers of Important Elements	191-192
• Major Aluminium Companies	173	• Properties of elements in the periodic table	192
• Important Economics Committees	173	• Isotopes of Important Elements	193
• Important Agricultural Revolutions	174	• Important Isotopes and their Uses	193
• Father of Important Agricultural Revolutions	174	• pH Value of Some Common Substances	194
• Schemes related to poverty and unemployment eradication	175	• Important Acid, their Sources & Uses	194
		• Changes in litmus paper in different solutions	195
		• Important Chemical Theories/Laws	195

Search On TG: @apna_pdf



• Common Name and Chemical Formula of Compounds	196-197	• Diseases Related to Blood	216
• Important Metals and their Ores	198	• Virus Borne Diseases	217
• Alloys, Composition and their Uses	199	• Fungi Borne Diseases	217
• Some Important Polymers	200	• Protozoa Borne Diseases	217
• Uses of Important Organic Compounds	200	• Worm Borne Diseases	218
		• Vaccination to Protect Against Diseases	218
		• Important Plant Diseases	219
		• Diseases Related to Animals	219
		• Major Medical Research Institutes in India	220
		• Gestation Period of Major Animals	220
		• Life Span of Major Animals	220
		• Number of Chromosomes in Animals/Crops	220
		• Cellular Excretory Substances	220
Biology			
• Father of Different Branches of Biology	201		
• Inventions in Medicine	201-202		
• Major Branches of Botany	202-203		
• Major Branches of Biology	203		
• Animals Includes in Phylum/Class of Animal Kingdom	204		
• Animal and their Number of Hearts	205		
• Animal and their Number of Eyes	205		
• Animal and their Urea Excretory Organ	205		
• Animal and their Respiratory Organ	205		
• pH Value of Human Organs/Secretions	206		
• Important Common Names and its Scientific Names	206		
• Different Cells and their shape	207		
• Fruits and their edible parts	207		
• Pigments Responsible for Color and Smell in Fruits and Vegetables	207		
• Smallest/Largest animal and plant in the world	208		
• Important Facts Related to Human Body	209		
• Important Facts of Human Organs	209		
• Diseases Related to Human Skeletal System	209		
• Human Skeleton Related fact	209		
• Major Glands of Animals	210		
• Hormone Secreted from Human Glands/Organs	210-211		
• Enzymes and Their Sources	211		
• Plant Hormones	211		
• Diseases due to Deficiency of Vitamins	212		
• Essential minor minerals for the human Body	213		
• Essential major minerals for the human Body	214		
• Possible Blood Groups in Children Based on Parental Blood Group	214		
• Different Types of Medical Test	215		
• Different Medical Devices and their Uses	215		
• Diseases caused by Various Factors and Affected Organs	216		
• Bacteria Borne Diseases	216		
• Diseases Related to Eyes	216		
Science and Technology			
• First in Space (Space Program)	221		
• Space Centres in India	222		
• Top Space Agencies in the World	223		
• Major Rocket Launching Stations in the World	223		
• Important Indian Satellites	223		
• Gaganyaan Mission	223		
• Facts Related to Chandrayaan-3 Mission	223		
• Navigation Systems of Different Countries	224		
• Major Missiles of India	224		
• Facts Related to AI Technology	225		
• Nuclear Power Station in India	225		
• Major Nuclear Research Institutions in India	225		
• Defence Production Units in India	226		
Computer			
• Father Related to Computer	227		
• Generations of Computer	227		
• 500 Global Supercomputers, 2024	228		
• Major Supercomputers of India	228		
• Other Types of Computers	228		
• Input/output devices	228		
• Computer Hardware and Their Inventors	228		
• Developers of High Level Language	229		
• Storage Device	229		
• Different levels of data records	229		
• Memory Measuring Units in Computers	230		
• Number System in Computers	230		
• Classification of Computer Networks	230		



• Internet	231	Miscellaneous	
• Internet Protocol : Uses and Applications	231	• First in India : Men	249
• Languages used in World Wide Web (www)	231	• First in India : Women	250
• International Institutes related to Internet	231	• First In World : Men	251
• Operating System	232	• First In World : Women	251-252
• Open Source Software	232	• First Females in the World	252
• Major Web Browsers	232	• First in India	252
• Major Search Engines	232	• Highest, Largest, Longest, Smallest in India	253-254
• Major Domains and their related Areas	233	• Longest, Largest, Biggest, Tallest/Highest, Fastest, Smallest in World	254-255
• Country Code Domains	233	• First in the World	255
• World's Leading Search engine websites/Social media sites	233	• Major Central Research Institutes in India	256
• Important Extensions File	234	• National Research Centres	257
• Important Computer Viruses	234-235	• Major Gardens in India	257-258
• Cyber Crimes Methods	235	• Major Museum in India	258-259
• Windows Keyboard Shortcut Keys	235	• Names currently changed in India	259-260
• MS Word Shortcut Keys	236	• Nobel Prize Winners of India	260
• MS Excel Shortcut Keys	236	• Places Related to Prominent People	260
• Computer : Abbreviations	237-238	• Sobriquet of Indian Cities	261-262
Sports		• Major Statue of India	262
• Major Sports and Their Related Play Grounds	239	• Indian Joint Military Exercises	263
• Important Sports Terminology	239	• Important Operations in India	263-264
• Major Sports and their Number of Players	240	• Government News Agencies of Major Countries	264
• Olympic Games-Host Country	240	• Sobriquets of Places (World)	264-265
• Commonwealth Games-Host Country	240	• Capital Currency and Language of Different Countries	266
• Asian Games-Host Country	240	• Independence Date of Major Countries	267
• ICC Men's World Cup Host & Winner	241	• Government Documents of Major Countries	267
• T-20 Men's World Cup Host and Winner	241	• International Years Declared by United Nations	267
• FIFA World Cup- Host Country	241	• International Organizations and their Headquarters	268
• Grand Slam	241	• Famous Indian Authors and their Books	269
• Country and their National Sports	241	• Famous Foreign Authors and their Books	270-271
• Major Sports and Their Related Cups and Trophies	242	• Important Symbols	271
• Famous Players and Their Nicknames	243	• Number of Letters in Different Languages	271
• Players and Their Books	244	• National Awards of Different Field	271
• Major Sports Institutes in India	244	• Important International Awards	272
• National Sports Awards	245	• Nobel Awards Receivers of 2023	272
• Major Stadiums in India	245	• List of Miss Universe/World of India	273
• Major Cricket Stadiums in World	246	• Geographical Indications Tag (GI Tag)	273-274
• Famous Players and Their Achievements	246-247	• State/Union Territories of India	275-278
• Special awards to winners and their coaches in international sports competitions	248		



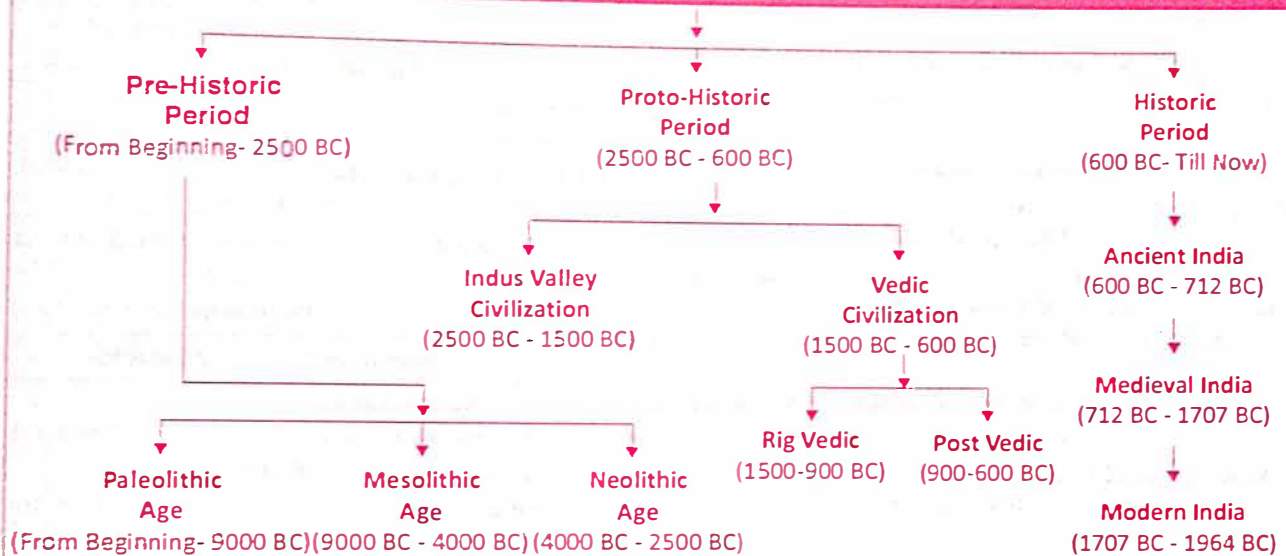
History of Ancient India



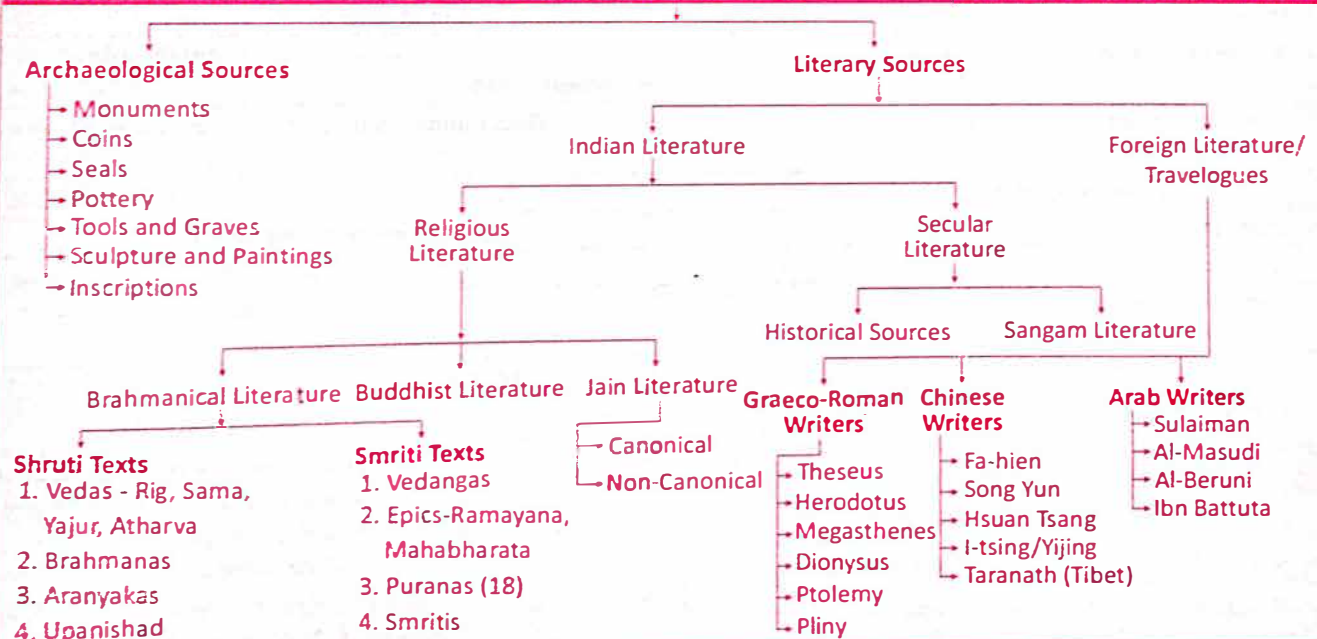
- ✓ Ancient Greek historian and geographer Herodotus is regarded as The Father of History. His work, The Histories, is the history of the Greco-Persian wars.
- ✓ The Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) was established in the year 1861 under the leadership of Alexander Cunningham, who also became its first Director General. Sir Alexander Cunningham is regarded as the Father of Indian Archaeology.



Parts of History



Historical Sources





Important Literatures of Ancient India

Books/Literature	Authors	Books/Literature	Authors
• Mahabhasya	Patanjali	• Arthashastra	Kautilya/Vishnugupta/Chanakya
• Mudrarakshasa	Vishakhadatta	• Buddhacharita	Asvaghosha
• Adi Purana	Jinasena	• Milinda Panha	Nagasena (Buddhist monk)
• Uttarapurana	Gunabhadra	• Natyashastra	Bharata Muni
• Brihatkathamajari	Kshemendra	• Kamasutra	Vatsyayana

- Ashvaghosha, who composed **Buddhacharita**, lived in whose court? – Kanishka (SSC GD, 2023)
- In which book were the rules written for the **Buddhist Sangha**? – Vinaya Pitaka (SSC MTS, 2022)
- Which Brahmana text is related to **Atharvaveda**? – Gopath Brahmin (SSC IMD, 2022)
- **Uttara Ramcharit** was written by which poet? – Bhavbhuti (SSC CHSL, 2023; DSSSB JE CE, 2019)
- Religious scripture, **Tripitaka** is related to which religion? – Buddhism (SSC MTS, 2019)
- The **Pali Canon** or **Tipitaka**, written in the 5th century BC, is the basic text of which religion? – Buddhism (SSC GD, 2019)
- The study of coins is called **numismatics**.
- Which is the most ancient source of **Nritya** (classical Indian dances)? – Abhinaya Darpanam (SSC CHSL, 2023)
- Who is considered the author of **Natyasastra**? – Bharata-Muni (SSC CHSL, 2023)
- In which **Upanishad** there is mention of seven musical notes named **Sa, Re, Ga, Ma, Pa, Dha** and **Ni**? – Narada Parivrajaka Upanishad (CRPF TRADESMAN, 2023)
- The words **Taittiriya, Brihadaranyaka** and **Mundaka** are related to? – Upanishads (RRC Group D, 2022)
- **Aitareya Upanishad** belongs to which **Veda**? – Rigveda (RRC Group D, 2022)
- Where were manuscripts usually written on? – On palm leaves (SSC MTS, 2021; CTET, 2018)
- Which book was written by **Panini**? – Ashtadhyayi (SSC CGL, 2020; SSC CGL, 2016)
- The study of inscriptions is called **epigraphy**.

Important Inscriptions & Related Facts

Inscription	Ruler	Related Facts
• Hathigumpha inscription	Kalinga King Kharavela	First mention of Bharat varsha .
• Aihole inscription	Pulakeshin II	Description of the battle between Pulakeshin II and Harshavardhana .
• Nasik inscription	Gautami Balashri II	Describes Gautamiputra Satakarni as the destroyer of Sakas (Shakas) .
• Junagarh (Girnar) inscription	Rudradaman	Description of construction and restoration of Sudarshan Lake .
• Mandsaur inscription	Malwa King Yashodharman	Description of the silk weavers migration .
• Gwalior inscription	Pratihara King Bhoj	Description of construction of Sun Temple by Matricheta .
• Deopara inscription	Bengal ruler Vijaysen	Description of the conquest of Kalinga and Kamarupa by King Vijaysen .
• Bhitari and Junagarh inscription	Skandagupta	Mention of Huna's invasion .

Chalcolithic Sites

• Inamgaon (Maharashtra)	• Daimabad (Maharashtra)
• Navdatoli (Maharashtra)	• Newasa (Maharashtra)
• Ganeshwar (Rajasthan)	• Gilund (Rajasthan)

- In which state is the prehistoric site of **Daimabad** located? – Maharashtra (SSC Steno, 2020)
- Where is the archaeological site **Inamgaon** located? – Maharashtra (SSC MTS, 2019)
- **Burzahom**, the neolithic site, is located in? – Jammu & Kashmir (SSC CHSL, 2021)

**Neolithic Sites**

• Burzahom (Kashmir)	• Mehrgarh (Baluchistan)	• Mahadaha (Uttar Pradesh)	• Koldihwa (Uttar Pradesh)
• Sangankallu (Karnataka)	• Piklihal (Karnataka)	• Chopani Mando (Uttar Pradesh)	• Chirand (Bihar)

Indus Valley Civilization Sites

	Site	Present Locallion	Excavators	Important Findings
1.	Harappa	Sahiwal District, Punjab Province, Pakistan (on the banks of Ravi river)	Dayaram Sahani (1921), Madho Swarup Vats (1926), Mortimer Wheeler (1946)	Copper Bullock cart, Granaries, Terracotta figurines, Coffin burials
2.	Mohenjo-daro (2nd largest IVC site)	Larkana District, Sindh Province, Pakistan (on the banks of Indus river)	Rakhal Das Banerjee (1922), Ernest Mackay (1927), Mortimer Wheeler (1930)	Great bath, Granary, Unicorn Seals, Bronze dancing girl statue, Pashupati Seal steatite statue of bearded priest
3.	Chanhudaro	Sindh Province, Pakistan (on the banks of Sindhu river)	Ernest Mackay (1925), N.G. Majumdar (1931, 1935-36)	Bangle Factory, InkPot, Bead makers shop, Footprint of a dog chasing a cat, Lipstick
4.	Kalibangan	Hanumangarh, Rajasthan (on the banks of Ghaghar river)	Amlananda Ghosh (1951), B.V. Lal and B.K. Thapar (1961)	Wooden plough, Copper Ox, Evidences of earthquake, Camel's bones, Furrowed land
5.	Kot Diji	Khairpur, Sindh Province, Pakistan (on the banks of Sindhu river)	J.S. Ghurye and Fazal Ahmed Khan (1955-1957)	Statues of bull, Statue of mother goddess Bronze rings
6.	Rangpur	Kathiawar District, Gujarat (on the banks of Bhadar river)	Ranganath Rao (1953-1954)	Plough (Clay Model), Fire altars and Seals in lower towns have been found
7.	Sutkagandor	On Makran coast, Pakistan (on the banks of Dashk River)	Aurel Stein (1927), George F. Dales	Trade point between Harappa and Babylon, Flint Blades, Stone Vessels
8.	Alamgirpur	Meerut District, Uttar Pradesh (on the banks of Hindon River)	Yagya Dutt Sharma (1958)	Shows Late Harappan Culture, Pottery and beads are the main findings
9.	Manda	Jammu (Jammu and Kashmir) (on the banks of Chenab river)	J.P. Joshi (1976-1977)	Evidence of beads
10.	Daimabad	Ahmednagar, Maharashtra (on the banks of Pravara river)	M.N. Deshpande (1958-59), S.R. Rao (1974-1975), S.A. Ali (1975-1979)	Two terracotta button-shaped seals, three potsherds with Harappan symbols
11.	Ropar	Ropar District, Punjab (On the banks of Satluj river)	Yagya Dutt Sharma (1953-1956)	Copper Axe , Seal of Selkhadi
12.	Surkotada	Kutch, Gujarat (on the banks of Sabarmati and Bhogavo river)	J.P. Joshi (1964)	Horse skekton, Oval grave, Pot burials
13.	Lothal	Ahmedabad, Gujarat (on the banks of Bhogavo river)	Ranganatha Rao (1955-1962)	Artificial Dockyard, Graveyard, Ivory weight balance, Copper dog, Rice husk, Chess-playing,

The book **Early History of India** by Vincent Arthur Smith (British) is a description of the history starting from 600 B.C..



	Site	Present Location	Excavators	Important Findings
14.	Rakhigarhi	Hisar, Haryana (on the banks of Ghaggar River)	Sooraj Bhan (1969) Amendra Nath (1997-2000)	Copper tools, Seal with Harappan script found.
15.	Sokhta Koh	Makran coast, Balochistan Province, Pakistan (on the banks of Shadi Kaur River)	George F. Dales (1962)	Evidence of pottery
16.	Banawali	Hisar, Haryana (on the banks of Rangoi River)	Ravindra Singh Bisht (1973)	Beads, Barley, Oval shaped settlement, the only city with radial streets
17.	Dholavira	Khadir Island, Kutch, Gujarat (on the banks of Luni River)	J.P. Joshi (1967-68), Ravindra Singh Bisht (1990-1991)	Only site to be divided into three parts, Water harnessing system
18.	Shortugai	Darqad District Takhar Province, Afghanistan (on the banks of Oxus/Amu Darya River)		- Terracotta statue found
19.	Amri	Near Baluchistan, Pakistan (on the banks of Indus River)	N.G. Majumdar (1929)	Evidences of Antelope and Rhinoceros evidence

- ▣ With which material are the **Harappan seals** made of?
– **Steatite** (SSC MTS, 2021; RRB NTPC, 2022; CRPF TRADESMAN, 2023)
- ▣ Which is the **only Harappan city** where **radial roads** have been found?
– **Banawali** (CRPF TRADESMAN, 2023)
- ▣ From which **Harappan site** evidences of **plowed fields, terracotta carts, symbolic tombs and fire altars** have been found?
– **Kalibangan** (Rajasthan) (CRPF TRADESMAN, 2023)
- ▣ Which **Harappan site** lacked a **fortification wall**?
– **Lothal** (SSC CPO, 2022; CRPF TRADESMAN, 2023)
- ▣ In what year was the **Harappan civilization** first discovered?
– **1921** (SSC CHSL, 2020; CRPF TRADESMAN, 2023)
- ▣ From which excavation site of the **Harappan Civilization** were **terracotta models of the plough** discovered?
– **Banawali** (SSC CHSL, 2020)
- ▣ According to acaelologists, what was the **smaller and higher, western part of Harappan cities** called?
– **Citadel** (SSC CHSL, 2022)
- ▣ Which **Harappan city** was located on the island of **Khadir Bet** in the **Rann of Kutch** and was **divided into three parts**?
– **Dholavira** (SSC CHSL, 2022)
- ▣ In which **direction** were the **fort built** in the **Harappan cities**?
– **West** (CRPF TRADESMAN, 2023)
- ▣ Which city served as the port of the **Indus Valley Civilization**?
– **Lothal** (SSC CHSL, 2022; SSC CHSL, 2023)
- ▣ What was the **shape of the great bath of Mohenjodaro**?
– **Rectangular** (SSC MTS, 2021; SSC MTS, 2022;)
- ▣ Which archaeological site of **Harappan civilization** is located near **Bolan Pass**?
– **Mehargarh** (SSC CGL, 2022)

Major Precious Items Imports by the Indus Valley Civilization

Material	Sites	Material	Sites
• Copper	Balochistan and Khetri (Rajasthan)	• Hessonite Stone	Saurashtra (Gujarat)
• Lapis Lazuli Stone	Afghanistan, Mesopotamia	• Lead	Afghanistan, Iran and South India
• Firoza Stone	Iran	• Gold	Afghanistan, Iran, Kolar (Karnataka)
• Silver	Jawar Mines of Rajasthan, Afghanistan and Iran	• Tin	Iran, Afghanistan, Central Asia

The Egyptian civilization, contemporary to the Indus Valley civilization, developed on the banks of the Nile River.



Major Ancient Vedic Terms

Ancient Name	Modern Name	Ancient Name	Modern Name
• Aghanya (Not to be killed)	Cow	• Hiranyakara	Goldsmith
• Gopa	Tribal Chief	• Gavishti	A fight for cows
• Goghna/Gohanta	Guest	• Dhanya	Cereals

Rig Vedic Period Rivers

Ancient Name	Modern Name	Ancient Name	Modern Name
• Sindhu	Indus	• Drishtwari/Saraswati	Ghaghar
• Vitasta	Jhelum	• Kubha	Kabul
• Askini	Chenab	• Suvastu	Swat
• Purushni	Ravi	• Gomati	Gomti
• Vipasha	Beas	• Sadanira	Gandak
• Shatudri	Satluj	• Krubh	Kurram

16 Major Rituals

1. Garbhadana	The first coming together of the husband and wife for bringing about conception.	7. Annaprasana	This ceremony is performed, when the child is given solid food (anna) for the first time.
2. Pumsavana	Ceremony performed when the first signs of conception are seen. It was to be performed when someone desires a male child.	8. Chudakarana	Chuda means the lock or tuft of hair kept, shaving off the rest of the hair.
3. Simantonayana	A ceremony of parting of the hairs of the expectant mother to keep her spirits high and positive. Special music is played for her.	9. Karna-vedha	Done in 7 th or 8 th month. Piercing of the ears.
4. Jatakarma	After the birth of the child, the child is given a secret name, and is given taste of honey and ghee. Mother starts the first breast-feeding after chanting of a mantra.	10. Upanayana	It is the ceremony of wearing the sacred thread.
5. Nama-karana	In this ceremony the child is given a formal name. Performed on the 11 th day.	11. Praishartha	It was the learning of Vedas and Upanishads either in Gurukul or pathshala.
6. Nishkarma	In this the formal darshan of sun and moon is done to the child.	12. Vidyarambha	It literally meant commencement of studies. It was done either when the child attains 3 or 5 years.
		13. Keshanta	Hairs are cut, guru dakshina is given.
		14. Samavartana	Ritual sending of a student life.
		15. Vivaha	Marriage ceremony.
		16. Antyesthi	The last rites done after death.

Types of Marriage (According to Grihya Sutras)

• Brahma Marriage	Marriage of a girl with the boy of same Varna with Vedic rites and rituals.	• Prajapati Marriage	Marriage without dowry.
• Daiva Marriage	Father donates his daughter to a priest as Dakshina.	• Gandharva Marriage	It was a kind of love marriage or Swyamavara.
• Arsa Marriage	A token bride-price of a Cow and Bull was given.	• Asura Marriage	Marriage by Purchase.
		• Rakshasha Marriage	Marriage by abduction
		• Paisach Marriage	Seduction of girl while sleeping

**24th Tirthankara of Jain Religion : Mahavira Swami**

• Year of Birth	540 BC	• Renunciation ordered by	From elder brother Nandivardhana (at the age of 30)
• Birth Place	Kundagrama, Vaishali, Bihar	• Enlightenment	Under the Sal tree after 12 years of rigorous penance
• Father	Siddhartha (Head of Jnatika clan of Vajji Sangh)	• Enlightenment Place	On the banks of Rijupaiika river in Jrimbhikagrama
• Mother	Trishala (Sister of Lichchavi ruler Chetak)	• Main Sermon	Situated on Vipulachala mountain in Rajgriha, on the banks of Varakar river
• Childhood name	Vardhamana	• Epithets	Kevalin (Kaivalya-highest spiritual knowledge), Jina (conqueror), Nirgrantha (without bonds), Arhat (worshiped).
• Spouse	Yashoda	• Nirvana (Moksha)	Pawapuri (Rajagriha), in the Malla Republic of Bihar, at house of a man named Sastipal (attained Nirvana at the age of 72 in 468 BC).
• Daughter	Anojja (Priyadarasana)		
• First Disciples	Jamali (son-in-law of Mahavir Swami)		
• Main Disciples	Makhaliputra Goshal (founder of the Ajivika sect)		
• Sermon Language	Prakrit (Ardhamagadhi) language		

**Major Jain Tirthankaras and their Symbols**

1.	Rishabha Deva (First)	Bull
2.	Ajitnath (Second)	Elephant
3.	Shantinath (Sixteenth)	Deer
4.	Parshvanath (Twenty Third)	Snake
5.	Mahavira (Twenty Fourth)	Lion

Five Principles of Jainism

1. Ahimsa (Non-Violence)	2. Satya (Truth)
3. Asteya (Non-Stealing)	4. Aparigraha (Non-Possession)
5. Brahmacharya (Celibacy)	
Above five principles, four principles were given by Parshvanath, while the fifth principle Brahmacharya was added by Mahavira.	

Jain Councils

Jain Councils	Place	President	Year
• 1 st Council	Pataliputra (Bihar)	Sthulabhadra	310 BC
• 2 nd Council	Vallabhi (Gujarat)	Devarddhigani	453 or 466 AD

- Who was the last (24th) Tirthankara of Jains?
-Vardhman Mahavir (SSC MTS, 2022; FCI, 2022)
- Who is the first Tirthankar of Jainism?
-Rishabhnantha (also known as Adinatha) (RRC Group D, 2022)
- According to Jain philosophy, what is the meaning of the word?
-Conqueror (SSC CGL, 2020)
- Lord Mahavira, who is known as Niganthanathaputra in Pali literature, founded which religion?
-Jainism (SSC CGL, 2020)
- In which present-day state was Lord Mahavira born?
- Bihar (SSC JE, 2020)
- At which place did Lord Mahavira attain salvation?
-Pavapuri (SSC MTS, 2021)

Important facts related to Jainism

• The disciples of Sthulbhadra were called Svetambara (wearing white clothes) and the disciples of Bhadrabahu were called Digambar (who remained naked).	• Reincarnation, Karmavada, Syadvada and Anekantavada are the fundamental doctrines of Jainism.
• Early Jain literature is written in Ardha-Magadhi language.	• Founder of Ajivika sect Makkhali Goshal.

Three Jewels of Jainism

1. Samyaktadarshana (Right Faith)
2. Samyaktjnana (Right Knowledge)
3. Samyakcharita (Right Conduct)



Founder of Buddhism : Mahatma Buddha

• Year of Birth	563 B.C.		• Renunciation Event	Mahabhinishkramana
• Childhood name	Siddhartha (Gotra-Gautam)		• Charioteer	Channa
• Mother	Mahamaya Devi (Koliya Republic)		• Horse	Kanthaka
• Father	Shuddhodhana (Shakya clan, ruled in Kapilvastu)		• First Teacher	Alara Kalama
• Birth Place	Lumbini Forest, Kapilvastu (Present place- Rummindei, Nepal)		• Disciples	Ananda and Upali
• Foster mother	Prajapati Gautami		• Enlightenment	Under the Peepal Tree (at age of 35 years)
• Spouse	Yashodhara (Princess of Koli Republic)		• Enlightenment Place	Bank of Niranjana River, Gaya (Bodhgaya, Bihar)
• Son	Rahul		• First Sermon	Rishipattana (Sarnath)
• Epithets	Tathagata Shakymuni Buddha		• Places of Preaching	Shakya, Kashi, Magadha, Anga, Malla, Vajji, Kosala state.
			• Mahaparinirvana (Death)	483 BC, age-80 years, day-Vaishakh Purnima, place-Kushinagar/ Kushinara (Uttar Pradesh)

Symbols related to life events of Buddha

Event	Symbol	Event	Symbol
1. Conceiving	Elephant	6. Prosperity	Lion
2. Birth	Lotus	7. 1 st Sermon	Chakra
3. Youth	Bull	8. Nirvana	Footsteps
4. Renunciation	Horse	9. Death	Stupa
5. Enlightenment	Bodhi tree		

Buddhist Councils

Councils	Year	Place	Presided	King
• First	483 B.C.	Rajgriha	Mahakasapa	Ajatshatru
• Second	383 B.C.	Vaishali	SabaKami	Kalashoka
• Third	246 – 250 B.C	Pataliputra	Moggali putta Tissa	Ashoka
• Fourth	100 B.C.	Kundalavana, Kashmir	Vasumitra Ashvaghosha	Kanishka

- ❑ What is the circumambulation path in the structure of the stupa? -Pradakshina path (CRPF TRADESMAN, 2023)
- ❑ What are the Buddhist stupas built to bury the remains of the body known as? -Reliquary stupas (SSC MTS, 2021; CRPF HCM, 2023)
- ❑ Who was the first woman to become a nun in Buddhism? -Mahaprajapati Gautami (SSC CGL, 2023)
- ❑ Which is the famous holy place of Buddhism, where Buddha gave his first sermon? -Sarnath (CRPF HCM, 2023)
- ❑ What is harmika in the structure of stupa? -A balcony-like structure on top of a semicircular mound (DSSSB LDC, 2019; CRPF TRADESMAN, 2023)
- ❑ Stupas are related to which religion? -Buddhism (SSC MTS, 2022)
- ❑ Tripitaka (3 baskets) is related to which religion? -Buddhism (RRC Group D, 2022)
- ❑ In Buddhist architectural monuments, what were the prayer hall known as? -Chaitya Griha (SSC MTS, 2022; SSC MTS, 2021)



- In which cave the painting named Padmapani Bhodisattva was found?
-Ajanta Cave 1 (SSC, CGL, 2020)

- The birthplace of Gautam Buddha was a forest, by what name was it known? -Lumbini (SSC CGL, 2020)

- At which place did Lord Buddha attain enlightenment?
-Bodhgaya (SSC CGL, 2020; SSC CGL, 2021)

- Mahaprajapati Gautami was the first woman to be chosen as a nun (Bhikkhuni) Whose foster mother was she?
-Gautam Buddha (SSC CHSL, 2020)

16-Mahajanapadas and their Capital				Important Facts
	Mahajanapada	Capital	Current Location	- Information about the rise of 16 Mahajanapadas is found in the Buddhist text Anguttara Nikaya and the Jain text Bhagwati Sutra. - Ashmaka is the only Mahajanapada of South India. - The real founder of the Magadha Empire, Bimbisara (Haryanka dynasty) ascended to the throne of Magadha in 544 BC. - Bimbisara sent his Rajvaidya Jeevak to serve Mahatma Buddha.
1.	Anga	Champa	Bhagalpur & Munger (Bihar)	
2.	Avanti	Ujjain/Mahishamati	Malwa (Madhya Pradesh)	
3.	Surasena	Mathura	Mathura (Uttar Pradesh)	
4.	Kashi	Varanasi	Varanasi (Uttar Pradesh)	
5.	Koshala	Shravasti/Ayodhya	Ayodhya Division (Uttar Pradesh)	
6.	Kuru	Indraprastha	Delhi, Meerut and Haryana	
7.	Kamboja	Rajapura	Rajouri and Hajara (South-West Kashmir)	
8.	Ashmaka	Potali/Podana	Godavari River Field (South India)	
9.	Chedi	Shuktimati	Bundelkhand Division (Uttar Pradesh)	
10.	Panchala	North Panchala (Ahichchatra) South Panchala (Kampilya)	Bareilly, Badayun & Farrukhabad (Uttar Pradesh)	
11.	Vajji	Vaishali/Mithila	Muzaffarpur & Darbhanga (Bihar)	
12.	Vatsa	Kaushambi	Kaushambi (Uttar Pradesh)	
13.	Magadha	Girivraj/Rajgir/Pataliputra	Patna & Gaya (Bihar)	
14.	Matsya	Virata Nagar	Jaipur, Alwar & Bharatpur (Rajasthan)	
15.	Malla	Pawapuri/Kushinagar	Devariya, Basti & Gorakhpur (Uttar Pradesh)	
16.	Gandhara	Taxila	Rawalpindi & Peshawar (Pakistan)	

- What was the capital of Avanti Mahajanapadas?
-Ujjaini (SSC Steno, 2019; SSC CHSL, 2023)

- What was the capital of the Mahajanapada Gandhara in the 6th century BCE?

- The ancient Champa city is considered the capital of which Mahajanapada? -Anga (SSC CGL, 2021; SSC GGL, 2022)

-Takshshila (SSC MTS, 2021, 2022)

- Rajgriha was the first capital of which Mahajanapada?
-Magadh (SSC MTS, 2022)

Empire of Magadha				Important Facts
Dynasty	Ruled Era	Founder	Last Ruler	- Bimbisara made Rajagriha his capital and was a follower of Buddhism. - Udayin was the first ruler who made Pataliputra as the capital. - Greek Writers have mentioned ruler Dhananand (Nanda dynasty) by the names Agrammes and Xandrames.
• Haryanka Dynasty	545 BC - 412 BC	Bimbisara	Nagadasaka	
• Shishunaga Dynasty	412 BC - 345 BC	Shishunaga	Nandivardhan	
• Nand Dynasty	345 BC - 322 BC	Mahapadma Nanda	Dhananand	
• Maurya Dynasty	322 BC - 185 BC	Chandragupta Maurya	Brihadratha	
• Shunga Dynasty	185 BC - 73 BC	Pushyamitra Shunga	Devabhuti	
• Kanva Dynasty	73 BC - 30 BC	Vasudev Kanva	Susarma	



Titles held by Ashoka

Titles		Sources	Titles		Sources
1.	Ashoka	Maski Minor Rock Edict	6.	Piyadasi Raja	Kandahar major rock edict, Deepvamsi, Mahavamsi
2.	Devanampriya Piyadasi, Ashoka Raja	Gurjara Minor Rock Edict	7.	Ashokavardhana	Purana
3.	Ashoka Maurya	Rudradaman's Junagadh inscription	8.	Raja Ashoka	Nettur Minor Edict
4.	Piyadasi Raja	Barabar Caves inscription	9.	Raja Ashoka Devanampriya	Udegolam Minor Edict
5.	Piyadasi Raja Magadha	Bhabru Bairat Minor Rock Edict			

Who was known as Devanampriya?

-Ashoka (SSC CHSL, 2019)

Emperor Ashoka was the son of which Maurya ruler?

Bindusara (SSC Steno, 2019; Allahabad High court RO, 2019)

Devanampriya and Piyadasi were the titles adopted by which king?

-Ashoka (SSC Steno, 2019)

Which Maurya ruler became a follower of Buddhism?

-Ashoka (SSC CHSL, 2019, 2020)

14 Major Rock Edicts of Ashoka

Edict	Message
I	Prohibits animal slaughter. Only two peacocks and one deer were killed in Ashoka's kitchen. He wished to discontinue this practice of animal slaughter.
II	Planting medicinal herbs and humans and animals were given medical treatment. Also mentions about the Cholas, the Pandyas, the Satiyaputras and the Keralaputras.
III	Pradeshikas, Rajukas and Yuktas going on inspection tours, preaching dhamma.
IV	Dhammaghosa replaced Bherighosha (war drum).
V	Appointment of Dhamma Mahamattas.
VI	Mantri Parishad and officers like Pulisani and Pativedakas (reporters).
VII	Religious tolerance in his own kingdom and in the neighbouring kingdoms.
VIII	Dhamma Yatras (dharma tours) replaced Vihara-Yatras (Royal pleasure tours).
IX	Emphasis on dhamma and moral conduct.
X	No desire for fame and glory by king.
XI	Policy of dhamma is the best policy to follow and a best gift.
XII	Appeals tolerance amongst all sects and people to honour the dhamma of others. Also mentions about mahamattas in charge of women's welfare (Ithijika Mahamatta).
XIII	Ashoka's victory over Kalinga. Victory of Ashoka's Dhamma over Greek Kings, Antiochus, Ptolemy, Antigonus, Magas, Alexander Cholas, Pandyas etc. This is the Largest Edict. It mentions Kamboj, Nabhaks, Bhoja, Andhra etc.
XIV	Describes engraving of inscriptions in different parts of country.

In which state is the Maski Rocks currently located?

-Karnataka (RRB NTPE, 2022; SSC CGL, 2023)

By what name was the region/territory south of the Ganges known in the ancient times?

-Magadh (MP TET, 2022; SSC MTS, 2022; BPSC (Pre), 2023)

Ashoka waged a war to conquer Kalinga. What is the Present-day name of Kalinga?

-Odisha (present Odisha) (SSC MTS, 2021; SSC CHSL Tier-I, 2022)

How much tax was collected during the Mahajanapadas period? -1/6 part of the crop produce (SSC MTS, 2021; SSC MTS, 2022)

What was the purpose behind the pillars of Ashoka?

-To spread religious policy (SSC MTS, 2022)

Who, with the help of Kautilya, overthrew the last Nanda ruler Dhanananda?

-Chandragupta Maurya (SSC MTS, 2022; SSC CGL, 2020)



- ❑ After which war did Ashoka abandoned the policy of territorial occupation? -Kalinga war (SSC MTS, 2022)
- ❑ According to the material mentioned in the edicts of Ashoka, how many major political centers were there in the Maurya Empire? -Five (SSC MTS, 2022)
- ❑ Which foreign invader surrendered his territories to Chandragupta Maurya? -Seleucus Nicator (SSC MTS, 2022)
- ❑ Who was the first scholar to decipher and read Ashoka's edict? -James Prinsep (SSC CGL, 2020-2021)
- ❑ According to the Ashoka's Edict, how many years after becoming the king, did Ashoka fight the war with Kalinga? -Eight (261 BC) (SSC CGL, 2020)
- ❑ Who was the last Maurya ruler to be killed by Pushyamitra Shunga? -Brihadratha (SSC CHSL, 2019)

Pillars Inscription of Ashoka

- | | |
|--|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Prayag Pillar Inscription — This pillar inscription was shifted from Kaushambi to Allahabad Fort by Akbar. • Delhi Topra — This pillar inscription was shifted from Topra to Delhi by Firoz Shah Tughlaq. All the 7 inscriptions are mentioned only on this pillar of Ashoka. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Delhi Meerut — This pillar inscription was shifted from Meerut to Delhi. • Rampurva — West Champaran (Bihar) • Lauriya Areraj — East Champaran (Bihar) • Lauriya Nandangarh — West Champaran (Bihar) |
|--|---|
- ❑ Whose praise is engraved on the Pillar of Ashoka in Allahabad (Prayagraj Prashasti)?
-Samudragupta (SSC GD, 2023)
 - ❑ In which place are the pillars containing inscriptions from three different periods, namely the Maurya period, the Gupta period and the Mughal period located?
-Allahabad (present day Prayagraj) (SSC CPO SI, 2019)
 - ❑ Which animal is depicted on the top of the Ashoka Pillar of Rampurva?
-Bull (SSC Steno Group C & D, 2022)
- James Prinsep was the first to successfully decipher Ashoka's inscriptions written in Brahmi script.

Foreign Invasion in Post Maurya Period

Foreign Invader	Year of Invasion	Native Place	Famous Ruler	Capital
• Indo Greeks	190 BC	Bactria, Afganistan	Meander/Milinda	Sialkot, Punjab, Pakistan
• Shakas/ Scythians	190 BC	Syria, Iran	Nahapana	Mentioned in inscriptions from Maharashtra and of Satvahana period
• Parthians/ Pahalavas	1 st BC-AD	Parthia, Iran	Gondophornes	A large number of coins have been discovered from Begram, Afghanistan
• Kushanas (Yu Chi)	15 BC	China, Turkmenistan	Kanishka	Paurushpur (Peshawar, Pakistan) Mathura

- Kushan ruler Kanishka started the Shaka Era in 78 AD and established a city called Kanishkapura.
- Series of foreign Invasion in India:- Indo Greeks → Shakas → Parthians → Kushanas.
- First ever gold coins were issued by the Kushan ruler Vima Kadphises.

- ❑ To which dynasty did the famous ruler Kanishka belong?
-Kushana dynasty (SSC GD, 2023)
- ❑ According to the Rabataka inscription, who was the ruler of the Kushan dynasty?
-Vim Kadphises (SSC IMD, 2022)
- ❑ Which famous ruler was known as Ashoka II?
-Kanishka (SSC MTS, 2022)
- ❑ Which sect did Kanishka follow?
-Mahayana Buddhist sect (RRB ALP, 2018)

The Kushana rulers issued the largest number of copper coins in northern and north-western India.